Hyperglycemia Warning Signs

High blood sugar builds more slowly than lows — but untreated highs can lead to dehydration, ketones, and emergency conditions like DKA or HHS.

>180
ABOVE TARGET
MG/DL

>250
CHECK KETONES
MG/DL

>300
URGENT IF RISING
OR WITH ILLNESS

Common high symptoms

- Increased thirst & dry mouth
- Frequent urination
- Blurred vision
- Fatigue / headache
- Hunger or nausea
- Slow-healing cuts

Possible ketone / DKA signs

- Fruity or acetone breath
- Deep, rapid breathing
- Vomiting, severe nausea
- Stomach pain
- Confusion or drowsiness
- Inability to keep fluids down

What to do when high

1. Confirm with a meter or sensor reading.
2. Drink water (unless restricted by clinician).
3. Take correction insulin only as prescribed.
4. Recheck in 1–2 hours; note trend.
5. If ≥250 mg/dL, check urine/blood ketones if instructed.
6. Avoid vigorous exercise if ketones are present.
7. Call your care team for persistent highs or illness.
8. Seek emergency care for DKA warning signs.

Seek emergency care if

Vomiting prevents keeping fluids down · moderate/large ketones with symptoms · difficulty breathing · confusion · glucose stays very high despite following your plan · suspected DKA or HHS.

Educational reference only — not medical advice. Correction dosing and ketone protocols are individualized. Never change insulin without clinician guidance.